

Azure Foundry RBAC Role Recommendations

Corporate Policy RAG - Phase 1 Development

Recommendation: Use Azure built-in roles. You do not need to create custom roles or a separate developer user account for the current single-developer proof of concept.

Recommended Role Assignments

Scope	Identity	Recommended role	Purpose
RAG development resource group	Your existing Microsoft Entra user	Contributor	Create and configure Azure resources in the development resource group.
Parent Foundry resource	Your existing Microsoft Entra user	Reader	View the parent Foundry resource and support project-level access.
Foundry project	Your existing Microsoft Entra user	Foundry User or Azure AI User	Use models, agents, tools, and project data-plane capabilities.

Why Contributor May Not Be Enough

Contributor primarily grants management-plane permissions, such as creating and configuring Azure resources. It does not necessarily grant all Foundry data-plane permissions needed to create agents, invoke project resources, or use project tools.

Foundry User / Azure AI User provides the project-level permissions needed for normal Foundry development. Assign it to your existing login at the Foundry project scope.

Where to Assign the Foundry Role

1. Open the Foundry project in the Azure portal or Microsoft Foundry portal.
2. Open Access control (IAM) or Management center > Users.
3. Select Add role assignment.
4. Choose Foundry User. If that name is not displayed, look for Azure AI User.
5. On the Members page, select User, group, or service principal.
6. Select your existing Microsoft Entra user account.
7. Complete Review + assign.

When Broader Foundry Roles Are Appropriate

Assign broader roles at the Foundry resource level only when you need to create multiple projects, manage shared deployments or connections, or administer access for multiple teams. Examples may include Foundry Project Manager, Foundry Account Owner, or Foundry Owner.

Azure Function Managed Identity

Do not automatically grant the Function App managed identity Contributor over the entire resource group. Assign only the data-access roles the application actually requires.

Target resource	Likely managed-identity role
Azure Blob Storage	Storage Blob Data Reader
Azure AI Search - query only	Search Index Data Reader
Azure AI Search - index updates	Search Index Data Contributor
Foundry project or agent	Foundry User or the applicable invocation role
Azure AI model resource	Applicable model-inference or Azure AI user role
Azure Key Vault	Key Vault Secrets User, only when secrets are required

Recommended Phase 1 Decision

- Keep Contributor on your existing human developer account at the development resource-group scope.
- Assign Foundry User or Azure AI User to that same account at the Foundry project scope.
- Use Reader on the parent Foundry resource if required for visibility and project access.
- Do not create a custom RBAC role.
- Do not create a separate developer user unless your organization requires separate administrator and developer identities.
- Use managed identities and narrowly scoped data roles for Azure Functions and other application services.